claim to despise: the bomb blasts in Mumbai in January 1993 and the 'Indian Mujahideen' terrorist attacks in Delhi, Jaipur, and Ahmedabad, in which bombs were set to go off in hospitals, marketplaces and playgrounds.[59] The actions of both Hindu and Muslim terrorists are anti-national; both aim to divide the country by polarising people along their religious identities; and both hope to profit politically from such polarisation.

India must not let either set of terrorists prevail.

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By 1996 the BJP had emerged as the largest single party in national elections, though the unwillingness of the 'secular' parties to ally with it had led to the collapse in thirteen days of its first attempt at forming a government. Two years later it was back, with an amiable conciliator, Prime Minister Atal Behari Vajpayee, heading a coalition government in 1998; though one more election intervened, this government lasted six years. The BJP, despite merely heading a coalition government, left no doubt about its ideological moorings, installing a plaque to honour Savarkar at the Andaman central jail where he had been imprisoned, while avoiding all mention of the obsequious letter of apology to the British that had won him his release. Describing himself as a 'prodigal son' longing to return to the 'parental doors of the government', despite the failure of his earlier letter of clemency in 1911 to obtain him a pardon, Savarkar wrote again on 14 November 1913:

> '[If] the government in their manifold beneficence and mercy release me, I for one cannot but be the staunchest advocate of constitutional progress and loyalty to the English government which is the foremost condition of that progress. As long as we are in jails, there cannot be real happiness and joy in hundreds and thousands of homes of His Majesty's subjects in India, for blood is thicker than water; but if we are released, the people will raise a shout of joy and gratitude to the government, who knows how to forgive and correct, more than how to chastise and avenge.'[60]

Savarkar went on to add:

> 'Moreover, my conversion to the constitutional line would bring back all those misled young men in India and abroad who were once looking up to me as their guide. I am ready to serve the government in any capacity they like, for as my conversion is conscientious so I hope my future conduct would be. By keeping me in jail, nothing can be got in comparison to